



香港海關

Customs and Excise Department

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Circular

**Circular to Money Service Operators
FATF launches public consultation on
Guidance to increase payment transparency**

The Financial Action Task Force (FATF) is inviting views of stakeholders from across industry on new guidance to support the implementation of strengthened FATF Standards on payment transparency when they come into effect. The draft Recommendation 16 Guidance for consultation can be found at: <https://www.fatf-gafi.org/en/publications/Fatfrecommendations/R16-Public-Consultation-June-2026.html>.

The revisions to FATF's Recommendation 16, agreed in June 2025, will keep pace with changes in the payment landscape, and strengthen the safety and security of the international payment system by increasing transparency of information that accompanies cross-border payments and requiring the introduction of tools to protect against fraud and error. All jurisdictions around the world are expected to be ready to implement the changes by the end of 2030.

Feedback is invited on a range of issues including whether the guidance provides sufficient clarity and support on:

- Detecting and preventing misdirected payments, including by leveraging the three options for alignment checks foreseen in the revised Standard;
- How Recommendation 16 applies to newer payment methods, such as digital wallets and mobile money; and
- Implementing Recommendation 16 and meeting data protection and privacy requirements together.

If you are interested in providing feedback to the consultation, please follow the relevant instruction in the above FATF's website and send your response by 21 August 2026, with a copy to mso_feedback@customs.gov.hk.

For enquiries, please contact Money Service Supervision Bureau of Customs and Excise Department at 3742 7742 or email to msoenquiry@customs.gov.hk.

Money Service Supervision Bureau

Customs and Excise Department

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